

Topic 2: Variation and classification

Students should:		Guidance
		<i>iPrimary Curriculum reference</i>
2.1	explain how living things can be classified according to shared features	know that living things are classified into broad groups according to common observable characteristics and based on similarities and differences <i>Year 3: Animal adaptations</i> the classification of animals to include vertebrates (fish, amphibians, reptiles, birds and mammals) and invertebrates (such as snails, slugs, worms, crabs, spiders and insects) <i>Year 4: Variation and classification</i> the classification of plants to include flowering plants (including grasses and trees) and non-flowering plants (such as ferns and mosses) <i>Year 4: Growing plants</i>
2.2	know how to use classification keys to help group, identify and name a variety of living things in the local and wider environment	identify and use the observable characteristics to classify a specific species of plant, for example flower colour, flower shape, leaf shape identify and use the observable characteristics to classify a specific species of animal, for example colour, body covering, number of legs <i>Year 4: Variation and classification</i> use a simple dichotomous key to identify a variety of plants <i>Year 4: Growing plants</i>